Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Integrated eBay Order, Inventory, 3PL, Warehouse and Finance Operating Platform

Version 0.1 (Draft for client review) | 29 October 2026 | Companion to the SRS v0.1

This PRD explains what we will build, for whom, and why, in business terms. Technical detail is in the SRS. Items marked **Decision needed** depend on your answers to the questions in Section 12.

1. Summary

You need one system that connects eBay orders, stock, suppliers, 3PL clients, the warehouse, shipping, invoices, payments, returns and profit. Today these are separate, so numbers do not match and staff re-type information. We will build an integrated platform in five phases, starting with eBay orders and a trustworthy stock record, and growing to full finance and reporting.

The core promise: **every order, stock movement and payment is linked to its source, so operational and financial reports always reconcile.**

2. Problem and Opportunity

Problem today	Effect on the business
Orders, stock and money live in different places	Stock counts and sales do not agree; overselling risk
Manual re-entry between eBay, spreadsheets and accounts	Slow, error-prone, hard to scale
No single view of profit per order, SKU or client	Pricing and client decisions are guesses
3PL clients cannot see their own stock and charges	More support calls and billing disputes
Weak audit trail for stock and money changes	Hard to find the cause of differences

3. Goals and Success Measures

The measures are proposals for your approval, because none were supplied.

Goal	Success measure	Target
One view of all eBay orders	Orders appearing in the system after being placed	Within 15 minutes, 100%
Accurate stock	Difference between system and physical count	Under 1%
No overselling	Orders shipped without stock available	Zero
Controlled purchasing	Stock receipts linked to a purchase order	100% unless a reason is given
Better 3PL service	Clients can see only their own stock, orders and invoices	Zero data leaks
Reliable finance	Unexplained differences between reports and ledgers	Zero
Know your profit	Profit shown per order, SKU, client and period	Available from Phase 4
Less manual work	Hours spent copying data between tools	Reduced, baseline to be measured

4. Users

User	What they need
Business owner (Super Admin)	Overall control, setup, high-level KPIs, approvals
Operations Manager	Order flow, stock health, approvals, supplier and returns handling
Warehouse staff	Clear pick, pack, receive and adjust tasks, with no cost or margin data

User	What they need
Finance user	Invoices, payments, expenses, profit and reconciliation
3PL client	A simple view of their own stock, orders, charges and invoices
Viewer	Read-only visibility for auditors or directors

5. Scope

5.1 In scope

eBay order import, products and SKUs, inventory with a full movement history, stock adjustments with approval, order management, suppliers and purchase orders, receiving, returns and refund records, warehouse locations, 3PL clients and portal, fulfilment, storage billing, manual shipping records, invoices, payments, expenses, profitability, 14 reports, alerts, audit log, search and export, user roles.

5.2 Not in the first release

Other marketplaces, label printing, barcode and handheld scanning, a native mobile app, multi-company, payment gateway, automatic accounting export, AI forecasting. The design will not block them.

5.3 Boundaries

- The platform records payments; it does not take payments.
- It is not a full accounting package. It keeps a balanced ledger and exports for your accountant.
- eBay is read-only at first (**Decision needed**: write-back of tracking and shipped status).

6. Release Plan

Phase	What you get	What it lets you do
1. Core operations	Login and roles, audit log, eBay order import, products, inventory history, stock adjustments, order management, basic dashboard and reports	See all orders and stock in one place and stop overselling
2. Purchasing and returns	Suppliers, purchase orders, receiving, warehouse locations, customers, returns	Control buying, bin-level stock and returns
3. 3PL	Client accounts and portal, fulfilment steps, storage billing	Serve clients and bill them for storage and handling
4. Finance	Invoices, payments, expenses, profitability, reconciliation	Know profit and what is owed and due
5. Alerts and advanced	Notification engine, advanced reports, carrier integration	Work faster with proactive alerts

Dashboard widgets and menu items for a later phase stay hidden until that phase is released.

7. Feature Requirements

Priority: **Must** is needed for the phase, **Should** is expected, **Could** is optional.

7.1 Orders and eBay (Phase 1)

Feature	User value	Priority
Connect eBay seller account(s)	Orders arrive without typing	Must
Automatic order import, no duplicates	Reliable order list	Must
Order list, search, filters, detail	Find any order fast	Must
Status flow: New, Confirmed, Allocated, Picked, Packed, Shipped, Delivered, Cancelled, Returned	Everyone sees the same state	Must

Feature	User value	Priority
Problem queue for unmatched products or unknown statuses	Nothing is silently lost	Must
Manual order entry for non-eBay sales	Cover phone or direct sales	Should

7.2 Inventory (Phases 1 and 2)

Feature	User value	Priority
Complete stock movement history, never edited	Explain any number	Must
Stock views: on hand, reserved, available, incoming, damaged, quarantined, missing	True availability	Must
Reserve on order confirmation, deduct on dispatch	No overselling	Must
Adjustments with reason and manager approval	Controlled corrections	Must
Low-stock indicators	Reorder in time	Must
Cycle counts	Faster, safer stock takes	Should
Bin and location tracking	Find stock quickly	Must (Phase 2)
Inventory value	Know what stock is worth	Must (Phase 2)

7.3 Purchasing and returns (Phase 2)

Feature	User value	Priority
Suppliers and purchase orders	Track what is on order	Must
Receiving with shortages and damage recorded	Accurate stock in	Must
Returns with inspection and outcome: restock, damaged, quarantine, dispose	Correct stock after a return	Must

Feature	User value	Priority
Refund record with amount and reason	Know the cost of returns	Must

7.4 3PL (Phase 3)

Feature	User value	Priority
Client accounts with their own rate card	Fair, repeatable pricing	Must
Client portal: own stock, orders, invoices	Fewer support calls	Must
Fulfilment steps with pick lists	Faster warehouse work	Must
Storage billing by pallet, shelf, bin, volume or item, with preview before posting	Accurate, explainable charges	Must
Inbound notices from clients	Plan receiving	Should

7.5 Finance (Phase 4)

Feature	User value	Priority
Invoices with numbering, VAT and PDF	Professional billing	Must
Payments recorded and matched to invoices	Know who has paid	Must
Supplier invoices and payments	Know what you owe	Must
Expenses with categories and approval	Complete cost picture	Must
Profit per order, SKU, client, period	Better decisions	Must
Reconciliation report	Confidence in the numbers	Must

7.6 Platform-wide

Feature	User value	Priority
Role-based access and client isolation	Right people see the right data	Must

Feature	User value	Priority
Audit log of every important change	Accountability	Must
Global search, filters and export to CSV and Excel	Speed	Must
Dashboard with 10 KPIs, each opening the records behind it	Trusted numbers	Must
14 standard reports	Management visibility	Must
Alerts for stock, sync problems, approvals, overdue invoices	Act early	Must (Phase 5)
Configurable rates, thresholds, VAT and cost fields	Change rules without a developer	Must

8. Key User Journeys

8.1 An eBay order is fulfilled

1. The order arrives automatically and shows as New.
2. Once confirmed, stock is reserved so it cannot be sold twice.
3. Warehouse staff pick, pack and record the tracking number.
4. On dispatch, stock is deducted and cost of goods is recorded.
5. The order shows Delivered and its profit is visible from Phase 4.

8.2 Stock arrives from a supplier

1. The manager creates and approves a purchase order. Stock shows as incoming.
2. Staff receive the goods and note any shortage or damage.
3. Stock and value update. The supplier invoice is matched and the amount owed is recorded.

8.3 A 3PL client checks their business

1. The client logs in and sees only their own dashboard.
2. They view stock, open orders and invoices.
3. Storage and handling charges are explained by the rate card and activity.

8.4 A return is processed

1. The return is opened with a reason.
2. After inspection, each item is restocked, marked damaged, quarantined or disposed.
3. Stock updates to match and the refund is recorded.

9. Dashboard KPIs (proposed definitions)

KPI	Meaning	From
Total Orders	Orders created in the period, excluding cancelled	Phase 1
Pending Orders	Orders not yet shipped or cancelled	Phase 1
Revenue	Order item totals excluding tax	Phase 1
Low Stock Items	Products at or below their threshold	Phase 1
Total Stock Units	Units in the warehouse, including damaged and quarantined	Phase 1
Inventory Value	Units times average cost	Phase 2
Supplier Payables	Unpaid supplier invoices	Phase 4
Client Receivables	Unpaid client invoices	Phase 4
Storage Revenue	Storage charges invoiced	Phase 4
Outstanding Payments	Receivables past their due date	Phase 4

10. Quality Expectations

Proposed targets, to be confirmed against your real volumes:

- Pages respond in under 2 seconds for normal use with 20 users at once.
- Standard reports run in under 10 seconds.
- The system is available 99.5% of the time, with daily backups.
- Works on current desktop, laptop and tablet browsers. Phone is limited to simple views and status updates.
- Passwords are protected, sensitive data is encrypted, every client sees only their own data, and all important actions are logged.

11. Assumptions, Dependencies and Risks

11.1 Assumptions (not yet approved)

- You sell your own stock and also fulfil for 3PL clients.
- One base currency and a configurable timezone.
- Payments are recorded manually; no payment gateway.
- Weighted average cost is used to value stock.
- Existing data will not be migrated unless you tell us otherwise.

11.2 Dependencies

Dependency	Needed by
eBay developer account and approved API access, checked against current eBay documentation	Start of Phase 1
Rule for when stock is reserved and deducted	Start of Phase 1
Product SKU list and how eBay listings map to it	Phase 1
Storage billing rules	Phase 3
VAT, currency and accounting policies	Phase 4
Carrier agreements and API access	Phase 5

11.3 Risks

Risk	Impact	Response
eBay access or API changes delay order import	High	Request access early; keep eBay behind a replaceable connection layer
Late answers on ownership or stock rules	High	Design with an owner on every record from the start
Scope grows beyond the plan	Medium	Change control and a separate future list
Real volumes exceed assumptions	Medium	Confirm volumes now, load test in Phase 1

Risk	Impact	Response
Data migration discovered late	Medium	Decide at the start whether it is needed

12. Decisions Needed From You

These six block the design. Please answer them before we finalize.

#	Question	Our proposal
1	Do you sell your own stock, fulfil for 3PL clients, or both? Will clients connect their own eBay accounts?	Both
2	At which eBay order state should stock be reserved, and when deducted?	Reserve when paid or confirmed, deduct at dispatch
3	Will more than one eBay account be connected from the start?	Yes, supported from day one
4	Which phase should returns, customers, audit logs, notifications and basic reports belong to?	Audit and basic reports in Phase 1, returns and customers in Phase 2
5	One warehouse first, or several?	Built for many, one shown at launch
6	Which stock valuation method?	Weighted average

Other questions (VAT and currency, storage billing basis, retention, volumes, migration, eBay write-back, notification channels) are listed in the SRS under Section 20 and Part 1.

13. Approval

Name	Role	Decision	Date
	Business owner		
	Operations lead		
	Finance lead		